

Project 02:

Object Poster



Posters by:

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Description:

In this project, you will take inspiration from your results in Project 1 and design a set of posters that use connotation and/or metaphor to convey a message or theme—beyond the standard denotation of your object—using type and image. In other words, now that you have a handle on the formal aspects of your object, how can you use text and typography to communicate something less concrete?

Part 1:

Think about your object's function and possible connotations related to it (associative meanings or narrative aspects of your object). Be open and creative, spanning from simple to complex ideas. Examples: apple → teacher's pet, lightbulb → bright idea.

In addition, think about single words, as well as single sentences, that could express your idea(s) clearly and interestingly. Then create a keyword list with 10 or more words, phrases, ideas.

Part 2:

Based on your ideas, consider what kind of poster you might want to make:

- Poster that [provokes an action](#) (political message, propaganda, public awareness, PSA)
- Poster that [promotes something](#) (events, concerts/performances, products/services, places)
- Poster that [presents information](#) (research, academic subjects, poetry, broadsides)
- Poster that [share an idea](#) (poster as art)

Begin sketching (many!) poster designs, conveying your intended messaging with typography and imagery. (Remember they'll be 18x24".) Start simple and build complexity (for example, start with hand-drawn sketches and quick thoughts). See typeface limitations below. You are only allowed 1 typeface.

Consider how the type and image relate to each other. How does changing one affect the meaning of the other? Consider the Language of Vision terms, and scale in particular. How does this design communicate at a distance? Up close?

Part 3:

Refine your designs and edit your selection to a final version. The final posters should provide a dynamic portrayal of your theme/message.

Requirements:

Typefaces:

- Please limit yourself to the usage of one typeface for this assignment.
- Two weights (styles) from within the same typeface family could potentially be used, if absolutely necessary.
- If you feel you really need a second, you'll have to explain/demonstrate why using only one cannot effectively solve the design problem. (I'll have a high bar for allowing this, so good luck!)
- A limited selection of typefaces that can be used for this project are listed below. These are all system fonts, but if you don't have any for some reason you can download them to your computer from here, or install them through [Adobe Type kit](#):
 - [Berthold Akzidenz Grotesk](#)
 - [Times New Roman](#)
 - [Garamond](#)
 - [Clarendon](#)
 - [Didot](#)
 - [Univers](#)
 - [Courier](#)
 - [Helvetica Neue](#)
 - Franklin Gothic
 - [Futura](#)
 - [Gill Sans](#)
 - [Arial](#)

Deliverables:

- Three 18" x 24" printed posters
- Digital version of final posters as 300dpi PDF

Inspiration:

<https://a-g-i.org/work/>

Goal:

Design a poster that communicate(s) a connotation, metaphor, or idea about your chosen object.

Objectives:

- Create expanded visuals connected to a previously given visual problem.
- Understand connotative meaning and/or the use of visual metaphor
- Create interesting imagery and combine it with a typographic message
- Understand how to use typography and messages to reinforce, or alter, an image's message.
- Demonstrate an understanding of how typography can influence imagery.
- Understand the importance of composition, hierarchy, and meaning.